

Apt-get is a command-line tool and it is used interactively. This command is used with scripts and passing any basic command syntax of the tools remains the same. While adding the `--purge` option to apt remove instantly configuration files. All the actions of apt commands like installation for removal of the packages, dependencies for repositories are log in `/var/log/dpkg'.log` log file.

Finding which package installed which file

Most of the time before the installation, it becomes crucial to know the belongings of the package file or its location. There are a variety of ways in which you can find out which package is installed or belongs to a file.

Apt file to find out the package providing file:

The APT file can index contents of the package and files available in repositories and allow you to search for all the packages. You can use this to search inside DEB packages, installed in your system as well as for the packages which are not in your machine but they are available to install from repositories.

- Aptfile cannot check for the package that provides the file in case you download the package and install it without a repository. This package needs to be present in the repositories for the file to be able to find it.
- The Apt file might not be on your system, and to install it on the Linux distribution systems, you have to use the command-

Terminal

```
Sudo apt install apt-file
```

- To update the database you have to use

```
Sudo apt-file update
```

Dpkg to find the package providing file

This can be used to find the files belonging to a package, and it is faster to use as compared to the former. Dpkg can actively search for the files belonging to installed packages, but if you are looking for a file that's not installed in your machine, then you have to use apt-file.

To use dpkg to find installed packages providing the file address, you have to run it with (`-S` or `--search`) flag which is also followed by the file name you wish to see if the package belongs to.

- `Dpkg -S ame`

For example, find out the package, `Cairo.h` belongs to (using `dpkg`)

Similar to Apt-file, this also shows multiple packages having files containing the name you have searched. You have to provide the full path of the file to gain access to the package containing the specific name. For example-